

Lesson 103:

Defense - Suits to Move with Urgency

1



ANTICIPATE

suits where you can
ESTABLISH TRICKS
before the declarer discards.

TIME IS IMPORTANT!

2



IMAGINE THE HONORS:

a challenging but
essential operation
for defense.

3



"NO PARKING" SUIT:

must be removed
urgently before the
declarer discards
losers.

4



COUNT THE DECLARER'S CARDS

to understand if they
have available discards.

5

AGGRESSIVE vs NEUTRAL OPENING LEAD



AGGRESSIVE:

when time
is running out,
take risks to
establish.



NEUTRAL:

when the
contract is
not in danger,
play passively.

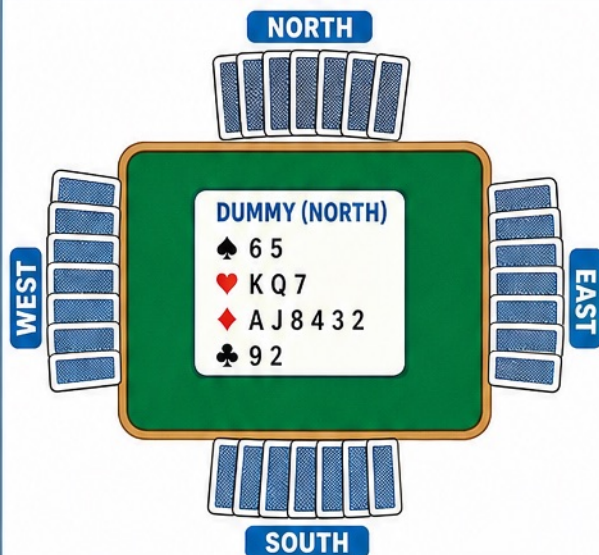
6

DUMMY WITH A LONG SUIT THAT CAN BE ESTABLISHED = URGENCY FOR DEFENDERS!



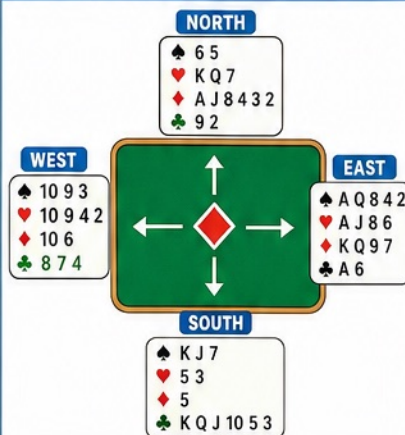
Act now, before the
declarer discards
from the long suit!

DIAGRAM: ESTABLISH THE LONG SUIT



Dummy has a long Diamond suit
that can be established.
Move Diamonds with urgency!

EXAMPLE: LEAD THE WEAK SUIT IMMEDIATELY



WHAT IS HAPPENING?

If you wait, declarer
will discard a losing
Diamond from
Dummy and the long
Diamond suit becomes
wasted.



RIGHT LEAD

Lead a weak suit
(such as a Club)
now, before the
declarer discards
from Dummy.



GOOD DEFENSE = ANTICIPATION + TIMING

Don't give the declarer the time they need!

